To further explain contract testing, it's helpful to have an overview of how traditional API integration testing works. Let's take an example of a web application that displays user details, which you can see in figure 1.1.

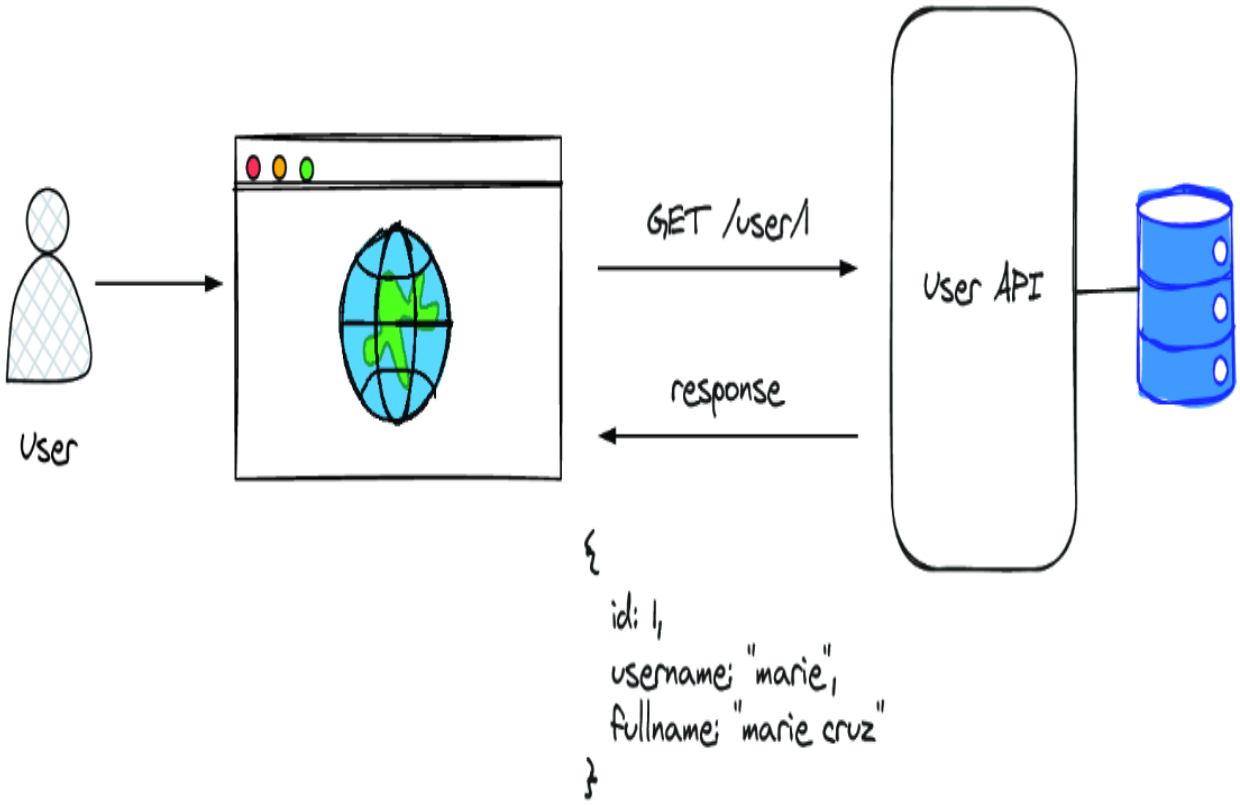


Figure 1.1 An example web application communicating with the User API. When a user sends a request to get their details, the User API sends the expected response.

A simple API integration test, as shown in figure 1.1, would send a `GET` request to the real User API and assert that it has the correct ID, username, and full name.

Contract testing, similar to API integration testing, will also assert that when the web application makes a `GET` request to the User API, their expectations should be true. The main difference here is that the web application and the User API don't need to interact directly. Instead, they interact via a shared contract, as shown in figure 1.2.